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PSAC Exam Practice Platform — Predicted Specimen Paper

2026

English

Paper 4 — Mauritius & the Environment

Grade: 5 Time allowed: 1 hour 30 minutes Total marks: 56

Name: _____ **Class:** _____

Instructions to candidates:

1. Write your name and class in the spaces provided above.
2. Answer **all** questions in all four sections.
3. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
4. The number of marks available for each question is shown in a box: 3
5. Read each question carefully before you begin to answer.
6. You may use a pencil for diagrams and rough work only.

Section	Marks available	Marks obtained
A — Reading Comprehension	15	
B — Grammar	20	
C — Vocabulary	10	
D — Writing	11	
TOTAL	56	

SECTION A — READING COMPREHENSION (15 marks)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Keeping Our Beaches Clean

Mauritius is famous for its beautiful beaches and sparkling blue lagoons. Every year, thousands of visitors come to enjoy the white sand and warm sea.

However, pollution is becoming a serious threat to these precious places.

Plastic bags, bottles, and food wrappers often end up on the beach, harming the animals that live nearby.

Last month, the pupils of Standard Five at Quatre Bornes Government School decided to make a difference. With the help of their teacher, Mr Lutchmanen, they organised a beach clean-up at La Preneuse beach. Thirty-two children arrived early on a Saturday morning, wearing gloves and carrying large black bags. In just two hours, they collected over forty kilograms of rubbish.

The children also made posters to remind visitors not to leave litter on the beach. One pupil, Ananya, said: "The ocean is the home of so many animals. If we do not protect it, we will lose it." Their action inspired many parents and local residents to join future clean-ups. Every small step we take today protects our island for tomorrow.

1. Why is pollution a threat to Mauritian beaches? Give **two** examples of litter mentioned in the passage. 3

2. What did the pupils of Standard Five organise? Describe **what they did** and **when**. 3

3. How much rubbish did the children collect? What else did they do to help protect the beach? 3

4. In your own words, explain what Ananya meant when she said: "**If we do not protect it, we will lose it.**" 3

5. The passage ends: "**Every small step we take today protects our island for tomorrow.**" Do you agree? Give a reason from the passage and one idea of your own. 3

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (20 marks)

- 6. Rewrite each sentence in the *present continuous tense*. Use *is/are + verb-ing*.**

5

- (a) The children collect litter on the beach.

- (b) Ananya makes a poster for the clean-up.

- (c) The waves wash the sand gently.

- (d) Local residents join the beach clean-up.

- (e) The teacher guides the pupils through the task.

- 7. Fill each blank with *a*, *an*, or *the*.**

5

(a) Mauritius is _____ island in _____ Indian Ocean.

(b) The pupils found _____ old bottle near _____ rocks.

(c) It was _____ amazing effort by all.

- 8. Choose the correct preposition and fill in the blank.**

5

Word bank: across around near without towards

- (a) The children walked _____ the lagoon to reach the beach.
(b) A turtle was spotted _____ the coral reef.
(c) We cannot protect the ocean _____ working together.
(d) The seabirds flew _____ the shore at sunset.
(e) Litter scattered _____ the whole beach area.

9. Tick (✓) the best adjective to complete each sentence.

5

- (a) Mauritius is famous for its _____ beaches.
☐ ugly ☐ beautiful ☐ frozen ☐ grey
- (b) Pollution is a _____ problem for our environment.
☐ tiny ☐ funny ☐ serious ☐ helpful
- (c) The children wore _____ gloves to pick up rubbish.
☐ protective ☐ broken ☐ tiny ☐ wet
- (d) The lagoon water was _____ and crystal clear.
☐ muddy ☐ frozen ☐ sparkling ☐ dark
- (e) Their action was truly _____ and inspired others.
☐ boring ☐ careless ☐ inspiring ☐ silly

SECTION C — VOCABULARY (10 marks)

10. Write the opposite of each word. Choose from the box.

5

Box: *clean protect harmful future local*

Word	Opposite
(a) dirty	
(b) foreign	
(c) harmless	
(d) destroy	
(e) past	

11. Fill each blank with a suitable word from the box. Each word is used once.

5

Box: *pollution precious inspire resident lagoon*

- (a) The blue _____ at Belle Mare is one of the most beautiful in the world.
- (b) Clean water is a _____ resource that we must protect.
- (c) The young pupils managed to _____ the whole community to act.
- (d) A _____ of Port Louis spoke at the community meeting about litter.
- (e) _____ from factories and cars is damaging the air we breathe.

SECTION D — WRITING (11 marks)

- 12. Write a short paragraph of about 80–100 words about what you and your family or school can do to protect the environment in Mauritius.**

11

Use the points below to help you:

- What is one problem that harms the environment in Mauritius?
- What can you do at school to help the environment?
- What can your family do at home?
- How will these actions help Mauritius in the future?

Marks: Content & ideas (4) | Language & grammar (4) | Spelling & punctuation (3)

Mark Scheme — Grade 5 English Predicted Paper 4

For teachers and parents only. Accept reasonable alternatives that show understanding. Award marks for the correct number of valid points made.

Q	Expected Answer	Marks
1	Pollution threatens animals and the beach. Litter examples from passage: plastic bags, bottles, food wrappers. Award 1 mark for the general threat; 1 mark per litter example (max 2).	3
2	They organised a beach clean-up at La Preneuse beach on a Saturday morning last month. 1 mark for what (clean-up); 1 mark for where; 1 mark for when.	3
3	They collected over forty kilograms of rubbish in two hours. They also made posters to remind visitors not to leave litter. 1 mark for the amount; 1 mark for posters; 1 mark for connecting both ideas.	3
4	Accept any paraphrase: if people keep polluting the ocean, all the sea animals and the beauty of the ocean will be gone / we will destroy the ocean if we do not look after it. 2 marks for a clear and relevant explanation; 1 mark for partial understanding.	3
5	Open-ended. Award: 1 mark for a clear opinion, 1 mark for a passage example (e.g. clean-up inspired more people to join), 1 mark for a personal idea (e.g. switching off lights, recycling, not littering).	3
6	(a) The children are collecting litter on the beach. (b) Ananya is making a poster for the clean-up. (c) The waves are washing the sand gently. (d) Local residents are joining the beach clean-up. (e) The teacher is guiding the pupils through the task. 1 mark each; must use correct is/are + -ing form.	5
7	(a) an, the (b) an, the (c) an. 1 mark per blank (5 blanks total).	5
8	(a) towards (b) near (c) without (d) across (e) around. 1 mark each.	5
9	(a) beautiful (b) serious (c) protective (d) sparkling (e) inspiring. 1 mark each.	5
10	(a) clean (b) local (c) harmful (d) protect (e) future. 1 mark each.	5
11	(a) lagoon (b) precious (c) inspire (d) resident (e) pollution. 1 mark each.	5
12	See writing bands below.	11
TOTAL		56

Writing bands (Q12):

Aspect	Full marks	Partial	0
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Content & ideas (4)	All 4 bullet points addressed; relevant to Mauritius and specific	2–3 points or vague / generic	Off-topic or blank
Language & grammar (4)	Correct tense, varied sentences, no major errors	Some errors but meaning clear	Very limited
Spelling & punctuation (3)	Mostly correct; full stops and capitals used	Several errors but readable	Very poor